



Andrew: Making data accessible

I'm Andrew and I'm a data and Insights Manager on the ads research Insights Team. What does that actually mean? I help my company Google, make better decisions through data and I also work with our data to tell stories for marketers. Basically data storytelling at scale. Accessibility should be built into everything we do. Accessibility is really about making sure that you are creating data visualization, graphs, charts, tables, that anyone can interact with whether they have a long term or even as a temporary form of impairment. It could be auditory, it could be visual, could be sensory in some way.

Typically the ones we talked about in data visualization have to deal with color and contrast. Or maybe they can't see. So there's a number of things you can do any visualizations as you're getting, ready to show people and bring it out into the world. To make it easier for them to understand your graph, and understand the points you're trying to make, and just to make yourself more inclusive, you're going to create this stuff and you're not going to be the one presenting it anymore. It's going to show up in a place where you won't be the one being able to navigate the data for people and frame it for people. And that's a good thing. But as it moves further away from you, you also won't be there standing by it being able to explain it to people and be like, hey, here's the point, or, hey, maybe you can't read or see this or maybe these colors are confusing, let me make sure that you got the point clearly.

It's just a way of making sure that everyone in the room is able to experience the thing you've worked so hard on and able to take away the point in a clear way that they too, can basically take action on the data that you spent all this time working with and making you know presentable for folks. So all these things, they're great for accessibility and they're more inclusive but they're also this making you a better data analyst and a

better storyteller, because they force you to become more empathetic of your audience and who's receiving your data. You're making this to move the hearts and minds of other people to convince someone else that this data is meaningful to them and they should take an action on it. Or they should know this and they should use this for the organization or for their lives or for whatever the thing may be. And so, by focusing on accessibility, by focusing on the audience, by making it more inclusive, you're making your data clear and more impactful for everyone.